EMCOMM (EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS) HAM (AMATEUR RADIO) OPERATOR

CARD 2 · FRONT · SIDE 1 OF 2

Sending a Church Form via Winlink

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A · CREATE THE FORM YOURSELF (report given by voice on the net, in person or on paper)

1. **Winlink Express → New Message → Select Template → Global Templates → Church of Jesus Christ EMCOMM Forms** → pick the form
   Disaster Report · Supply Order · Work Crew Log. To practice: …*EMCOMM Practice* has seven pre-filled exercise forms
2. **Fill in the form** that opens in your browser
   Drill or test? Tick **THIS IS AN EXERCISE** at the top. Your callsign and station fill in from Winlink. **Save Data** keeps a copy.
3. **Submit → address it to *your* EOC (Emergency Operations Center) → Open Session → Telnet**, or VARA FM / VARA HF (VARA: the radio modem Winlink uses) when the internet is down (back)
   Your Satellite or Stake Center EOC's Winlink address is on the stake Comms Sheet.
4. **Confirm** it is in Sent Items, then report on the net

B · SEND A FORM A VOLUNTEER FILLED IN (a .txt save file from the portal)

5. **Receive the .txt file** — text, email or USB (Universal Serial Bus) drive
6. **Step 1, then Load Data** → select the file → every field fills in. Review, then send as in steps 3–4
   Your callsign and station are never overwritten. No GPS (Global Positioning System) position in the file? Your station's fills in.

Key phrase up: "Stake EOC, this is [callsign], I have transmitted [N] forms via [PACE level]. Receipt confirmed."
PACE: Primary, Alternate, Contingency, Emergency.

Submit says "localhost refused"? Nothing was sent. Close every localhost:8001 tab and the message, Select Template again, Load Data, Submit. One form open at a time.

Before every event: Winlink Express (`winlink.org`) and VARA FM / VARA HF (`downloads.winlink.org/VARA Products/`) installed and tested · templates in `Global Folders\Templates\Church of Jesus Christ EMCOMM Forms\` · Telnet tested within 30 days · nearest RMS (Radio Message Server) gateway programmed (winlink.org/RMSChannels). Send a monthly test message, a different PACE level each month.

Turn over → Card 2, side 2: PACE Levels: Which Path, When to Step Down

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PACE Levels: Which Path, When to Step Down

PACE	Situation	Winlink Connection
P	Cell + internet up	Volunteers text/email files to the EOC. You: Open Session → **Telnet**
A	Cell down, any internet anywhere	Home, a shelter, a business, Starlink: any connection that still reaches the internet. Files arrive by email or USB drive. Open Session → **Telnet**
C	No internet; a gateway answers	**Data:** Open Session → **VARA FM Winlink** → [pre-programmed VHF/UHF gateway freq] (very/ultra high frequency); no local gateway: **VARA HF** (high frequency) → 40m or 80m freq **Voice:** stake VHF/UHF net (repeater, then simplex); volunteers on FRS/GMRS (Family Radio Service / General Mobile Radio Service) to Team Leaders. Type voice reports into the template.
C	No gateway works	**Winlink peer-to-peer (P2P)** over VARA FM straight to a nearby EOC's station. **iPhone reports:** a USB-C/Lightning thumb drive in the go-kit, or the EOC Wi-Fi **Send to EOC**.
E	Nothing connects, no one answers the net	**Runner:** the volunteer's printed form (**Print** under the form) or a blank paper form filled by hand, carried to the EOC; operator types it in. Hold saved files and send when any path returns.

Addresses, gateways, nets: from the stake **Comms Sheet** — printed copy in the go-bag, or load the sheet file on your phone at …/`forms/comms.html` (works without service). The EOC sends a new one when anything changes.

PACE rule: step down a level after two failed attempts in 15 minutes, or when the Stake President decides it. Do not go back to a path that failed until a test message gets through. The stake Welfare and Self-Reliance Specialist (emergency communications) recommends the level, the Stake President decides, and the Emergency Response Director (ERD) or the specialist announces the level in force on the net. The county may call ARES (Amateur Radio Emergency Service) operators to county duty at its Emergency level; agree beforehand who stays with the stake.

Church of Jesus Christ EMCOMM is an independent volunteer project created by Travis Hilton (W9TLH), not an official product of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.